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About the Author

Cedric Mount is a considerable distinguished playwright of his age. He wrote some thoughtful plays, which include *Twentieth Century Lullaby*, *To cut a Long Short Story Short* and *Nature Abhors a Vacuum*. His one act plays are easy to perform, satirical, witty and insightful. These one act plays expose the shams of contemporary society besides delicately admonishing the guilty.



Glossary:

lounge – a place in a home or public building for leisure activities, living room

cosy – comfortable

instalment – one of the parts into which a debt is divided when payment is made at intervals

absurd – ridiculously unreasonable and meaningless

propose – intend to do something

realise – to understand or become aware of

thingummies – small articles the names of which are not remembered

motto – a short sentence or phrase that expresses a rule guiding the behaviour of a particular person or group

endorse – to make over to another

tartar – a person of irritable temper

possessed – completely controlled by an evil spirit

A. Reading Comprehension Questions:

1. What did Aunt Jane like about Jack's 'little nest'?
2. Aunt Jane seemed to think that there was a mistake in the wedding present she had given Jack. Why?
3. What would make Jack the owner instead of being the tenant?
4. What sounded absurd to Aunt Jane?
5. How did Jack manage to pay seven pounds eighty and eighty pence out of six pounds?
6. What advice did Aunt Jane offer the couple?
7. For what purpose did Aunt Jane wish to use the cheque given by Aunt Jane?
8. 'Just one more instalment and BABY'S REALLY OURS!' This tells us that the couple _____.

B. Answer the following questions in about a paragraph of 100 – 150 words each:

1. Why is there a double negative in the title: The Never – Never Nest? Elucidate with reasons from the play.